

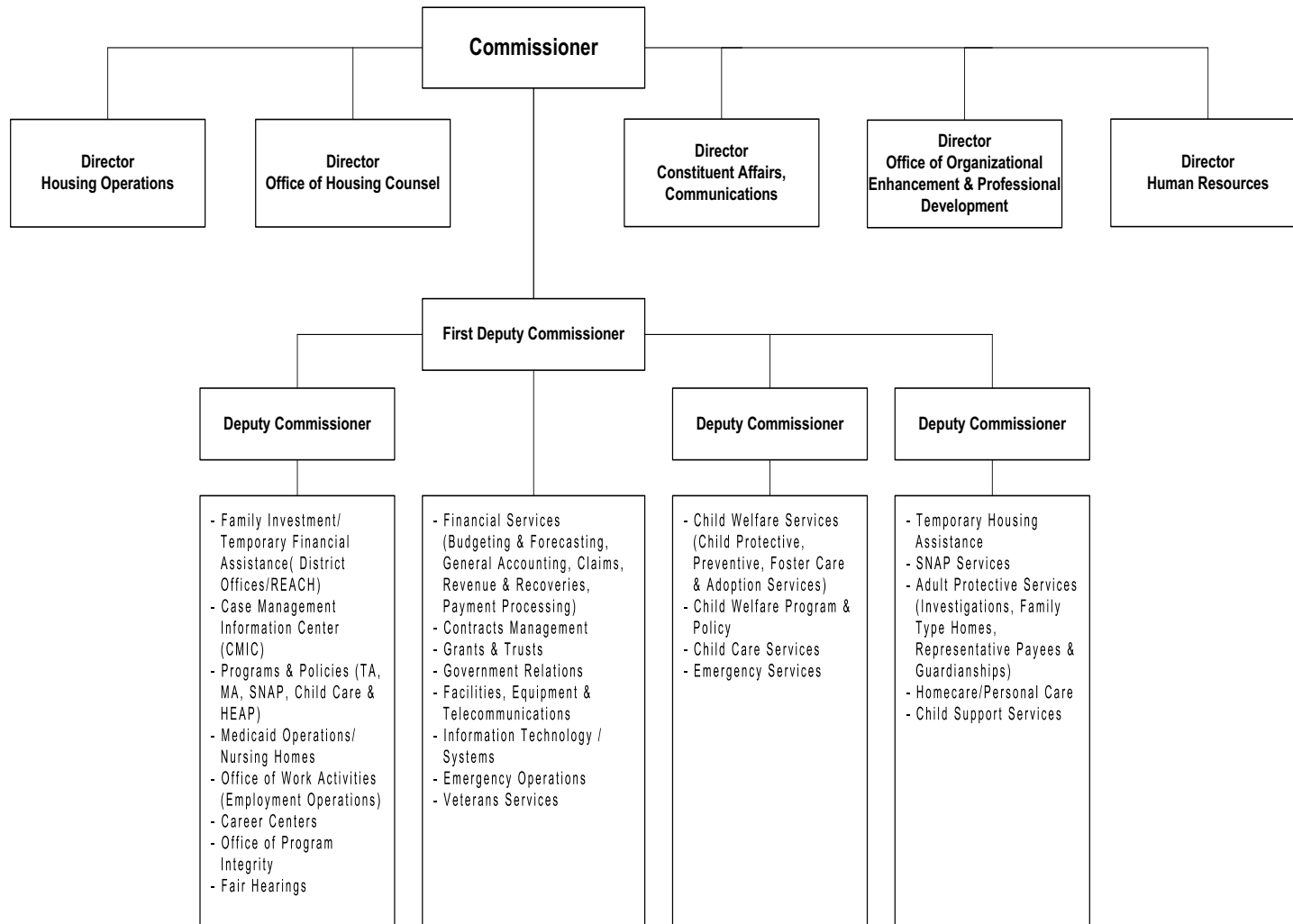
County Clerk (21)

Account Class	Account Rollup Name	Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
100 Annual Regular Salaries	1010 Net-Annual Regular	4,383,595	4,701,467	4,701,467	4,701,467	4,772,465	4,772,465
		4,383,595	4,701,467	4,701,467	4,701,467	4,772,465	4,772,465
101 Other Personal Services	1400 Overtime	12,099	20,000	20,000	20,000	20,000	20,000
		12,099	20,000	20,000	20,000	20,000	20,000
200 Equipment	2300 Replacement	3,048	10,790	10,790	10,790	2,800	2,800
	2400 Additional	45	16,485	16,485	16,485	11,685	11,685
		3,094	27,275	27,275	27,275	14,485	14,485
300 Material & Supplies	3010 Automotive Supplies	1,176	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,000	1,000
	3070 Book and Periodicals	0	400	400	400	100	100
	3600 Printing & Office Suppl	52,685	60,000	60,000	60,000	55,000	55,000
	3700 Postage Costs	60,042	60,000	60,000	60,000	45,000	45,000
		113,902	121,600	121,600	121,600	101,100	101,100
400 Expenses	4070 Equip Service & Rental	53,525	59,654	59,654	59,654	60,104	60,104
	4100 Membership Fees	845	1,000	1,000	1,000	1,000	1,000
	4110 Travel and Meals	800	9,200	9,200	9,200	9,250	9,250
	4160 Telephone Expenses	831	1,100	1,100	1,100	1,000	1,000
	4250 Public & Legal Notices	0	100	100	100	100	100
	4420 Technical Services	27,527	28,200	28,200	28,200	28,879	28,879
		83,528	99,254	99,254	99,254	100,333	100,333
599 Inter-Departmental Charge	5205 Information Support Svc	1,823,007	1,866,625	1,866,625	1,866,625	1,950,168	1,908,885
	5280 Svc by Public Works	2,779	11,307	11,307	11,307	3,568	3,207
	5325 Svc by Dept of Law	15,435	10,638	10,638	10,638	12,732	12,454
		1,841,221	1,888,570	1,888,570	1,888,570	1,966,468	1,924,546
Total Expenditures		6,437,440	6,858,166	6,858,166	6,858,166	6,974,851	6,932,929
Net Expenditures		6,437,440	6,858,166	6,858,166	6,858,166	6,974,851	6,932,929

County Clerk (21)

Account Class	Account Rollup Name	Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
50 Departmental Income		6,749,837	6,905,397	6,905,397	6,905,397	6,904,001	6,904,001
	Total Revenues	6,749,837	6,905,397	6,905,397	6,905,397	6,904,001	6,904,001
	Net Department Total	(312,398)	(47,231)	(47,231)	(47,231)	70,850	28,928

Dept Of Social Services (22)



The Commissioner of Social Services is appointed by the County Executive, subject to confirmation by the Board of Legislators.

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Mission Statement

The mission of the Department of Social Services is to empower its customers to become independent and to ensure the health, safety and protection of vulnerable adults and children.

	2024	2025
POSITIONS		
Operating	1,086	1,088
Grants	30	35
	1,116	1,123
OPERATING BUDGET EXPENDITURES		
Personal Services	88,657,563	90,267,802
Equipment	407,663	217,374
Material & Supplies	878,336	848,896
Expenses	26,180,738	26,183,877
Relief	544,981,736	586,031,072
Interdepartmental Charges	44,186,621	45,810,126
TOTAL EXPENDITURES	705,292,657	749,359,147
OPERATING BUDGET REVENUES		
Interdepartmental		
Departmental	4,042,000	4,805,000
State and Federal Aid	303,336,599	326,688,000
TOTAL REVENUES	307,378,599	331,493,000
DEPARTMENT TAX LEVY	397,914,058	417,866,147
Estimated Share of Miscellaneous Budget Items:		
Retirement Systems	24,329,870	26,432,097
Health Insurance and Benefits	38,282,101	39,856,756
DEPARTMENT TOTAL	460,526,029	484,155,000

The Appropriated 2024 figures in the supporting detail include all budget amendments through August 31, 2024 and Appropriations Assigned for Purchases on Order ("roll forwards") of \$184,725.

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Article XVII of the New York State Constitution establishes that "the aid, care and support of the needy are public concerns" and will be provided for by the State. To fulfill this mandate, New York State Social Services Law (cf. Article 3) establishes a state-supervised, locally administered system. Even programs of assistance established by the federal government are carried out under state supervision by the 58 local social services districts in New York. Most, but not all, mandates for the provision of social services require financial participation by the local social services district and can be found in Title 18 of New York State Codes, Rules and Regulations (NYCRR).

Programs and Services

Establishment of Paternity and Enforcement of Child Support

Medical Assistance

Family Assistance

Safety Net Assistance

Emergency Assistance to Needy Families with Children

Staff Development

Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP)

Home Energy Assistance Program

Emergency Assistance for Adults

Scope of Social Services

Organizational Requirements for Social Services

Program Requirements for Social Services

Consolidated Services Plan

State Law or Regulations

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 347

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 360

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 369

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 370

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 372

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 386

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 387

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 393

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 397

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Section 400

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 402

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 403

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Section 407

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Programs and Services

Child Care Services
Standards of practice for Adoption Services
Preventive Services Regulations
Title IV E Foster Care, Adoption, Kinship Guardianship Assistance
Child Abuse and Maltreatment
Child Care Agencies
Adult Protective Services
Residential Placement Services for Adults (Family Type Homes)
Homemaker Services
Adult Care Facilities
Medical Care
Shelter for Families

State Law or Regulations

NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 415
NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 421
NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 423
NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 426
NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 432
NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Parts 441 through 451
NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 457
NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 457
NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 485,486,489
NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 485, 491
NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 500
NYS Codes Rules & Regulations, Title 18 Part 900

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PROGRAM AREAS AND SERVICES:

SERVICES FOR ADULTS, CHILDREN AND FAMILIES WITH CHILDREN

The department's Child Welfare and Adult Protective divisions provide these essential services:

- ✓ **Child Protective Services (CPS)** investigates all reports of alleged child abuse and neglect in order to identify and protect vulnerable children in Westchester County.
- ✓ **Preventive Services** reduces the risk of foster care placement through direct services to families whose children are at risk of placement. These services can be court ordered or voluntarily received.
- ✓ **Foster Care** is temporary out-of-home care for children who cannot be safely left in the custody of parents or other caretakers. The range of care is from placement with a kinship foster family, foster family, or in a specialized residential facility.
- ✓ **Adoption Services** are provided to children who are unable to return to their birth families, and to the families who adopt them.
- ✓ **Independent Living Services** prepare children in the care and custody of the Commissioner to live independently as responsible adults.
- ✓ **Adult Protective Services** are provided without regard to income to assist adults age 18 or older who, because of mental and/or physical impairments, cannot provide for their basic needs for food, clothing, shelter or medical care, and who have no one willing and able to help in a responsible manner.

SERVICES TO THE GENERAL PUBLIC

The Office of Child Support Services assists in the collection of support payments for both public assistance households and non-public assistance households upon request.

The Office of Veterans' Services is available to assist all Veterans and their dependents in Westchester County in receiving the maximum benefits to which they are entitled.

The Westchester-Putnam Workforce Development Board

oversees Career Centers in Mount Vernon, Peekskill and White Plains and utilizes both public and private resources to train individuals in the skills needed to become employable or retain their jobs while assisting employers in building, training and/or retraining a skilled workforce.

TEMPORARY ASSISTANCE PROGRAMS

The department administers these temporary assistance programs:

- ✓ **Cash assistance programs for emergencies (EAA:** Emergency Assistance to Adults; **EAF:** Emergency Assistance to Families; **ESNA:** Emergency Safety Net Assistance).
- ✓ **Cash assistance programs for on-going financial needs (TANF:** Temporary Assistance to Needy Families; **SNA:** Safety Net Assistance to Adults; **SNF:** Safety Net Assistance to Families).
- ✓ **Child Care Assistance** for temporary assistance, low-income and Scholarship eligible households.
- ✓ **HEAP:** The federally funded Home Energy Assistance Program (HEAP) helps low-income households pay heating and cooling costs. It has five primary components. Regular HEAP helps the lowest income households, who pay a high percentage of their earnings for home energy, in meeting their immediate energy costs. Emergency HEAP helps eligible households facing heat-related emergencies. Cooling Assistance helps eligible households pay for cooling equipment during the summer months. The Heating Equipment Repair or Replacement program helps eligible homeowners repair or replace equipment necessary to keep their primary heating source working. The Clean and Tune benefit helps eligible households maintain primary heating equipment as well install carbon monoxide detectors or programmable thermostats, if needed, to allow for safe, proper and efficient operation.
- ✓ **Medicaid:** Medical assistance is available to help individuals who cannot afford to pay for their medical care. Each of the programs offered has unique eligibility criteria. Many individuals receiving Medical Assistance in Westchester County receive services through enrollment in a Managed Care plan of their choice. Medical Assistance is in a multi-year transition to a State take-over of most

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functions. However, applications will continue to be accepted and processed in 2025 at all department district offices.

- ✓ **SNAP:** the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (formerly Food Stamps).
- ✓ **Temporary Housing Assistance: (THA) for homeless households:** whether single, a childless couple or a family with children.
- ✓ **Office of Medical Home Care Services:** Medical Home Care Services is staffed by caseworkers and nursing staff responsible for Personal Care, Short Term Personal Care, Children's Waiver, Assisted Living Program, Managed Long Term Care Program, Comprehensive Care Management, Private Duty Nursing Services and Coordinated Care with Certified Home Health Agencies, Hospices and Hospitals, and Medicaid Eligibility workers who handle re-determination of patients in receipt of home care.

Applications for cash assistance, Medicaid and SNAP programs administered by the department may be submitted online through MyBenefits.ny.gov. They may also be submitted at any of four district offices (Mount Vernon, Peekskill, White Plains and Yonkers). Child care assistance applications for non-public assistance households can be submitted at 10 County Center Road in White Plains. HEAP applications can be obtained at any district office or on line and mailed in. While emergency and immediate needs are assessed at a district office, temporary housing assistance cases once opened are handled centrally in White Plains.

NOTE: Cash assistance and SNAP benefits require that most, but not all, recipients engage in work activity (excluding any emergency waivers). The department has restructured its employment programs into an Office of Work Activities focused on job placement. For employable-but-not-job-ready applicants and recipients, the focus is on overcoming barriers to job placement and retention through basic educational achievement and other job preparation, as well as community work experience. Recipients unable to participate in work activities due to substance abuse and/or other mental health issues must participate in treatment and accept monitoring of their progress. Recipients with barriers to employment that cannot be overcome are evaluated for the federal SSI program.

SERVICES DURING NON-BUSINESS HOURS AND EMERGENCIES

The Westchester County Department of Social Services' Emergency Services unit, provides after-hours and weekend coverage for all service emergencies, including investigation of child abuse reports from the State Central Register, placements in temporary housing, and other safety related responses. Emergency Services (ES) staff are tasked with initiating contacts on all child abuse and maltreatment reports received from the SCR between 4pm and 8am during the week, as well as on weekends and holidays. Emergency Services caseworkers are available on site at one of our centrally located District Offices and are supported by on call staff to meet the emergency needs of Westchester County families. These staff work in collaboration with law enforcement and other community first responders. For the first half of 2024, ES staff has been the initial responders to 1,299 SCR reports, handled 777 follow up referrals from our daytime staff, and facilitated the placement of 240 families in need of temporary housing.

WCDSS is also a key participant in the county government's emergency planning and assistance during periods that warrant a "disaster and recovery" response such as in the event of hurricanes, flooding, the destruction of multiple houses or apartment building due to a fire, etc. During these types of emergencies, as necessary, the department participates in the operation of reception centers, and field emergency applications to assess and assist Westchester County residents in need of food and emergency housing.

2024 Caseload and Program Highlights

Medical Assistance Beneficiary caseload changes: for the first six months of 2024, the department's Medicaid caseload is down by 1,212 cases to a total of 47,619 cases, which covers 50,005 individual recipients, down by 1,372 from 51,377 in December 2023 due to post pandemic adjustments by NYS. However, MA cases opened directly by agents for NYS in the Health Benefit Exchange (HBE) on behalf of Westchester residents since January 1, 2014 represent an additional 110,711 cases covering 187,393 more individuals as of July 2024. Westchester pays the

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local share up to the Medicaid cap for both the cases it carries and cases opened by New York State's agent for Westchester residents.

SNAP caseload decreased from 41,612 in June 2023 to 41,149 in June of 2024. The individuals covered under these SNAP cases decreased from 69,647 in June 2023 to 68,526 in June of 2024.

Adult Protective Services (APS) responds to requests from the community for information and assistance, conducts home visits in order to complete safety and need assessments and investigates allegations of neglect, self-neglect, financial exploitation and/or abuse by others. APS also investigates allegations of financial exploitation and works alongside the District Attorney's office to cease exploitation of vulnerable adults and holding the perpetrators accountable. APS provides referral information to individuals for services such as legal, medical, housing, case management, home care, and mental health supports. APS meets on a monthly basis with a multi-disciplinary team which consists of the District Attorney's office, Pace Women's Justice Center, The Weinberg Center, Legal Services of Hudson Valley, Department of Community Mental Health, Family Services of Westchester, Department of Senior Programs, and New York State Attorney General's Office. A case consultation model is used to improve the health and quality of life for older adults by reviewing, discussing, and coordinating cases of elder abuse, neglect, self-neglect, and financial exploitation, while identifying systemic and resource problems as well as strategizing interventions. APS is equipped with an Eligibility Examiner who assists Home-bound clients with facilitating the Public Assistance benefits (Medicaid, SNAP, HEAP, Temporary Assistance, Rent Arrears, Emergency Assistance) application process. The Eligibility Examiner conducts home visits to support the client completing the application from home. APS arranges for professional heavy duty cleaning and sanitation of client homes in order to prevent eviction and to improve the health and safety of the resident's environment. APS serves adults as their Social Security benefit Representative Payee, either directly or via contract, most often in order to preserve housing and ensure the payment of utility bills, when these adults have been determined to require a Payee. APS partners with several food pantries in order to access food supply to deliver food to those in need. APS manages the Family Type Homes for Adults (FTHA) Program which assists New York State in the recruitment, inspection, investigation and licensing of community homes. FTHA provides a home-like living environment. It is a community-integrated and supported housing

alternative for dependent adults who can no longer live alone due to advanced age, developmental disabilities, or physical or mental health, but who do not require skilled medical or nursing services. APS also seeks legal guardianship of individuals that lack capacity to care for themselves or agree that they need protection to care for their person, property or both. APS has partnered with the Department of Community Mental Health (DCMH) in order to co-respond to requests for assistance regarding those individuals who may require assistance from both APS and DCMH.

Child Care Assistance: Child Care Assistance is critical to keeping area families employed and businesses staffed thereby strengthening the local economy. Child Care Assistance is also instrumental in supporting families with Preventative Service involvement. The family fee remains at 1% of household countable income. The maximum number of paid absences across all provider modalities is 80 per program year and 20 paid program closures are also allowed per program year. Currently, the eligibility guidelines for low-income child care assistance are 85% of the state median income (SMI). The market rate paid to providers remains at the 80 percentile. In addition to the Low Income Child Care Program, Westchester offers a scholarship program, the Westchester Works Scholarship. Direct deposit of child care payments is expected in 2025.

Child Support Services: The Westchester County Office of Child Support Services collected \$71.6 million dollars through December 2023, and expects to collect \$72 million by the end of 2024. Currently, collections appear to have stabilized for the 2023/2024 Fiscal years.

Office of Program Integrity: Since its inception, the Front-End Detection System (FEDS) has consistently produced significant cost avoidance during the application process with a diversion rate of almost 50%. This includes submitting new FEDS/EVR referrals, conducting investigations, and completing monthly reports. The total cost avoidance for January to June 2024 was \$3,721,280. The Fraud Investigations Unit, with the assistance of a Westchester County Police Detective and the Westchester County District Attorney's Office, continues to investigate reported instances of Temporary Assistance, SNAP, Child Care Subsidy and Medicaid fraud. During the first two quarters of 2024, the Fraud Investigations Unit has received over 368 new fraud allegations and 448 skimming benefit replacement related requests totaling \$194,605.19. The unit's efforts have resulted in the discovery of 40 overpayments. Furthermore, Program Integrity oversees the

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processing and completing of various computer matches sent to the agency from The NYS Office of Temporary and Disability Assistance (OTDA) as well as NYS Department of Health. The result of these investigations has produced a cost avoidance of \$2,411,948 in the first 6 months of 2024. The Field Investigation and Child Care Audit investigated over 950 total Child Care cases, with a total cost avoidance of \$1,290,432.

Office of Temporary Financial Services: OTFS is the Program Division for Temporary Assistance, SNAP, Medicaid, Child Care, Employment, Child Support, Program Integrity, Housing and HEAP. OTFS also handles various contracts and initiatives, lawsuit settlement response tracking, audits, mailings and special projects. In the TA program, the recurring transportation allowance is now \$132.00 per month. The MetroCard's base single ride fare for subways and local bus increased from \$2.75 to 2.90 in 2023 and the cost for express bus now costs \$7.50. The 30 day Unlimited Ride increased to \$132.00. The 7 day Unlimited Ride fare increased from \$33 to \$34. Effective January 2024 the standard mileage rates established by the IRS increased from 65.5 cents per mile to 67 cents for business mileage. Medical/moving mileage remains unchanged at 22 cents per mile. Temporary Assistance financial eligibility is based on the Net Income Needs Test. The Earned Income Disregard (EID) from 62% to 63% plus a Work Expense Deduction of \$150 monthly. A new 100% Earned Income Disregard (EID) was implemented on December 29, 2023 that disregards 100% of new earned work or training income for a maximum of 6-months per lifetime per individual. The Covid waivers on telephonic signatures, interviews, and work requirements are set to expire by the end of 2024. The agency must continue to screen for employment readiness and advise the applicant/recipient of the employment policy and resources. The Home Energy Assistance Program (HEAP) Operations continue to expand as a program with multiple components (Clean and Tune, Cooling Assistance, Heating Equipment Repair Replacement (HERR), two emergency benefits and the Low Income Home Energy Assistance Program (LIHEAP) overlapping throughout the year. The HERR allowance remains \$8,500 while the CAC program increased to \$800 for a fan, window unit, or portable air conditioner, and up to \$1,000 per household for an existing wall sleeve unit once in a 5-year period. The C&T benefit increased to \$500 per program year. HEAP continues to work with Con Edison to facilitate

enrollment of Low Income Households into the LIHEAP program. This partnership requires a mass mailing every quarter.

CURRENT DEPARTMENT INITIATIVES

Case-banking Centers: All non-public assistance SNAP cases are handled centrally through 112 East Post Road in White Plains and all non-public assistance Medicaid cases are handled centrally through 100 East First Street in Mt. Vernon. The department offers once-a-business day on demand pick-up by messenger of applications requiring expedited processing from health care facilities.

Case Management Information Center: The Case Management and Information Center (CMIC) was created in response to the workloads of both individual staff and the needs of the Westchester County Department of Social Services as a whole. CMIC has been able to resolve 60% of the calls it has received without needing to direct customers to their workers. CMIC and the automated system received 35,924 calls in June 2024 and CMIC agents handled 10,401 calls. Out of the 10,401 calls, 6,279 calls were resolved by CMIC agents without directing customers to case managers and only 4,122 customers were referred to case managers and/or supervisors for resolving their issues. The average wait time for customers in queue to speak to an agent for 2024 YTD was 16 minutes. This higher than normal wait time is being addressed by prioritizing CMIC vacancies. The goals of CMIC have evolved to include the following:

- ◆ Maintain control over the large influx of customer phone calls
- ◆ Identify, categorize and track incoming calls
- ◆ Resolve routine and non-eligibility issues so workers may prioritize processing cases
- ◆ Improve customer service experience
- ◆ Reduce customer complaints

Customer Service: Applicants, recipients and colleagues are all entitled to be treated professionally and with respect at all times. While reception areas at district offices can be busy, the department's executive leadership is committed to ensuring that all applicants and recipients are treated respectfully, hence the CMIC and the *"One county: One application process"* initiative for district offices handling applications for assistance.